THE HOLLOW HEIR

The Props Book

Things to make with paper, clay and yarn

Every prop matches a moment the game already has. Templates to print and cut out are at the back.

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Version 1.0

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PROPS

Things to hold in your hands

Paper, glue, air-dry clay and black yarn. Every prop here matches something that already happens in the game, so the phone and the prop always agree.

Your players loved the props on the first night, so this book gives you more of them. Each one turns up at a moment the game already has: a clue they pick up, a quest reward, a trial on Day 7. When the app gives them the item, you hand them the real thing. The templates at the back are printed at the right size: print them at **100%** (not "fit to page"), cut inside the lines, and glue.

Before you start

- **Air-dry clay needs time.** Small pieces dry in a day, thick ones take two or three. Make everything a few days before the session, and turn pieces over halfway so the bottom dries too.
- **Keep clay at least as thick as a pencil.** Thin edges crack and snap when they dry. If a crack appears, smooth in a little wet clay.
- **Press, don't carve.** Runes and pictures look best pressed into soft clay with a toothpick, the tip of a pencil, a fork or a paper clip.
- **Make paper look old.** Brush on strong cold tea or coffee, let it dry, then crumple it and flatten it again. Tear the edges instead of cutting them. Never burn them.
- **Colour without paint.** Rub pencil graphite or a black marker into pressed lines and wipe the top clean, so the lines stay dark. Yellow or orange marker makes clay look gold.
- **Black yarn ties everything.** Roll scrolls and tie them, hang tags from it, and keep a long tangle for the Devil's Snare.

What to make, and when it comes out

Prop	Made from	Comes out when	Template
Secret gift cards	Paper, clay seal, yarn	Start of session 2, with the student books	T1
Family keepsakes	Paper, clay tag, yarn	Session 2 (or when the secret comes up)	T2
The Golden Snitch	Clay, paper wings	The Old Cup quest (after detention), at the Astronomy Tower	T3
Rune tablets (3)	Clay	Day 1 Library, Day 2 Greenhouses, Day 3 Hagrid's hut	T4
Ring clues (3)	Paper	Day 1: Trophy Room, Astronomy Tower (inside the Snitch), Owlery	T5
The Turning Lock	Paper discs and a pencil	Days 5 to 6: the Room of Requirement	T6
Vale's diary (3 pages)	Paper	Day 3 Restricted Section, Day 4 Black Lake, Day 6 Shrieking Shack	T7
The torn map edge	Paper	Fenwick's half now. The other half on Day 4	T7
Owl letter seals	Clay, yarn	Whenever you send an owl with a parcel	none
Devil's Snare	Black yarn	Day 7: the first of the Trials Beneath	none
The Seven Bottles	Clay, paper labels	Day 7: the last trial	T8

Is there Quidditch?

Not a match, no. But Quidditch is in the castle: Madam Hooch teaches **Flying Lessons** on the Quidditch Pitch, the Trophy Room is full of old cups, and one hidden quest, **The Old Cup**, starts with a Quidditch trophy. That is where your Golden Snitch goes.

The Golden Snitch

The story. Long ago, a forgotten house team won the cup in the Trophy Room. Their Seeker kept the winning Snitch and hid something inside it at the top of the Astronomy Tower. When a student polishes that cup in detention, they read the engraving: “Where the stars are closest, the second ring waits.” At the Astronomy Tower they find the Snitch, and inside it, the star chart for the Turning Lock.

How to make it

- Roll a ball of clay the size of a walnut. Push a pencil about two thirds of the way in, wiggle it to make a hole, and pull it out.
- Press two curved lines around the middle with a toothpick, like seams. With a knife, cut a thin slit on each side for the wings.
- Let it dry for two days. Colour it gold with a yellow or orange marker (or wrap it in yellow paper and glue it down).
- Cut the two wings from template T3, fold each along its spine for strength, and glue them into the slits.
- Roll the star chart (T5) tightly, tie it with a short piece of black yarn, and slide it into the hole.

At the table

The moment they reach the Astronomy Tower on The Old Cup, put the Snitch on the table in front of them, before the app says anything. Let them work out that something is inside. Then complete the objective on the GM screen, and the star chart appears in their Bag.

> **TIP**
>
> Make a second, smaller Snitch with no scroll. On the day of Flying Lessons, hide it somewhere in the real room before the session. The first student who spots it and catches it earns **+5 house points**. Madam Hooch is impressed.

The rune tablets

Three slates, each with three pictures and the word for each picture carved underneath in runes. They are how the players learn the rune alphabet. The app already shows them on the phone; the clay version is what they pass around the table.

How to make them

- Roll clay flat, about as thick as your little finger, and cut a slab the size of a phone (or a little smaller). Break a corner off and stick it back on with a smear of wet clay, so it looks cracked and mended.
- Lay template T4 on top and press through the paper along each rune with a toothpick, then lift the paper and deepen the lines. Draw each little picture the same way.
- Let them dry, then rub graphite or black marker into the lines and wipe the surface. The **hearth** slate is soot-black: rub graphite over the whole thing. The **garden** slate is mossy: a little green marker in the cracks.

> **TIP**
>
> Hand over the slate when they pick the tablet up in the app. They keep it until the end of the campaign, next to their rune notebook. Watching them hold two slates side by side to compare runes is the best part.

The ring clues and the Turning Lock

Three clues, each naming one symbol: a scratched note (Trophy Room), a star chart (Astronomy Tower, inside the Snitch) and a feathered card (Owlery). Together they open the Turning Lock in the Room of Requirement.

- **Clues (T5):** print, tea-stain and cut out. Scratch over the note with a pin so it looks clawed. Fold the feathered card in half and glue a paper feather to the front.
- **The lock (T6):** glue the base and the three rings onto cereal-box card before cutting them out. Stack them, biggest at the bottom, and push a pencil through all four centres. The arrow on the base stays still; the rings turn. (The base is only a little bigger than ring 1, so the arrow peeks out above it.)
- **Clay version:** make three thick clay rings that slide onto the pencil, and press the six symbols into the edge of each, in the order printed on T6.

> **TIP**
>
> Put the paper lock in front of them the moment they find the chest. Let them turn it with their hands while the puzzle is up on the TV. When they think they have it, they say it out loud and you solve it on the GM screen.

Vale's diary and the torn map

The diary (T7) is three pages in Vale's runes. Tea-stain them dark, tear the edges, and give each page as it is found. Once they have all three, they lay them side by side and decode the whole thing.

The map is one sheet torn in two. Draw a rough castle on an old-looking sheet of paper (copy the TV map if you like), then tear it down the middle with a zig-zag tear. Glue the rune strip from T7 along the torn edge of the left half. That half belongs to the Fenwick from the start: give it to them at the next session. Keep the right half yourself. On Day 4, when they win it from Cassius Thorne, hand it over and let them fit the torn edges together.

Owl letter seals

When you send someone a parcel by owl, give them a real folded letter as well. Press a ball of clay flat onto a circle of paper, and stamp it with the end of a pen, a button, a coin edge or a fork before it dries. Make a handful at once and keep them in a box. Fold the letter, tie it with black yarn, and push a dry seal under the knot with a dot of glue.

> **TIP**
>
> A sleeping draught for the student with the snoring dorm-mate: a tiny clay bottle on a piece of yarn, tied to the letter.

The Devil's Snare

Before Day 7, cut five or six long pieces of black yarn and tangle them loosely together. When the party falls into the Devil's Snare, drop the tangle over their hands on the table.

> **READ ALOUD**
>
> *The vines curl around your wrists. The more you struggle, the tighter they hold.*

Each time a player says they struggle, pull the yarn a little tighter. It lets go when someone casts light or fire at it (Lumos Solem or Incendio), or when they all go still and calm. Then the fight on the GM screen begins (or ends).

The Seven Bottles

Seven little clay bottles: two tall, two small, two round and one tiny. Let them dry, then wrap each in its paper label from T8 (number and colour). Line them up in order, and put the riddle card in front of them.

> **TIP**
>
> Let them pick up the bottles and move them around while they argue. When they agree, the one who drinks lifts the bottle and says its number, and you solve the puzzle on the GM screen.

Secret gifts and family keepsakes

At the start of session 2, when you hand back the student books, slip each player a sealed card (T1). Inside is the secret they told you about, written as a gift: what it does every day, what it does once a day, and its drawback. Give the same gift on the GM screen too (Players tab, **Give a secret gift**), so it is on their phone.

Keepsakes (T2) are one small paper object for each family's secret. Each is a reminder of the mystery they arrived with. Give them out with the gift cards, or the first time that secret matters.

Family	Gift	A clay token to go with it (optional)
Blackwood	Spider-Speech	Spiders were left out of the game on purpose before, so keep them to words: no clay spiders and no spider pictures, unless you have checked with your table first.
Sinclair	Fashionably Late	A clay pocket watch: a flat disc with a loop of yarn, its hands pressed in at a quarter past.
Fenwick	Green Thumb	A little clay seed pod, or a Mandrake root with a tiny angry face.

Family	Gift	A clay token to go with it (optional)
Thornbury	Rat-Speech	A tiny clay rat with a black yarn tail.
Quill	Mirror Self	A small round clay hand-mirror, with a circle of foil or shiny paper glued in.
Penrose	The Battered Suitcase	A matchbox-sized paper suitcase with the letters N.S. on the handle, and the three creature cards from T1 inside.
Okafor	The Invisibility Cloak	A small square of grey paper folded like a cloak, with “Do not lose” written inside.

T1 Secret gift cards

Cut out, fold in half on the dotted line (the gift inside), and seal with a clay seal. Hand them out at the start of session 2.

cut out, fold on the middle line, seal shut

FOR THE EYES OF THE

BLACKWOOD

and nobody else.

clay seal here

Open it alone. Tell no one.

THE THING NOBODY AT HOGWARTS KNOWS

Spider-Speech

Always. You understand spiders, and they understand you. They live in every corner of the castle, and they notice everything.

Once a day. Ask the spiders in a room what they saw there since yesterday. The DM answers in a few short, whispery words.

The catch. Spiders want paying: give up a food item from your Bag, or they ignore you until tomorrow. And they will not go anywhere near the covered painting.

cut out, fold on the middle line, seal shut

FOR THE EYES OF THE

SINCLAIR

and nobody else.

clay seal here

Open it alone. Tell no one.

THE THING NOBODY AT HOGWARTS KNOWS

Fashionably Late

Always. You are late for everything. But the castle seems to bend around it: you always turn up at exactly the moment things get interesting.

Once a day. Burst into a scene or a fight that has already started, wherever the others are. In a fight you join at the start of the next round, and your first spell gets +2 to hit.

The catch. At every morning class the DM rolls a d20 for you. On 1 to 6 you are late: lose 5 house points, and the teacher remembers your name for the wrong reasons.

T1 Secret gift cards

Cut out, fold in half on the dotted line (the gift inside), and seal with a clay seal. Hand them out at the start of session 2.

cut out, fold on the middle line, seal shut

FOR THE EYES OF THE

FENWICK

and nobody else.

clay seal here

Open it alone. Tell no one.

THE THING NOBODY AT HOGWARTS KNOWS

Green Thumb

Always. Plants like you. You know any plant on sight (what it does, and whether it bites), you roll with advantage in Herbology, and you can learn Herbology spells nobody else is taught.

Once a day. Ask a plant for help: a vine lowers itself for you to climb, a hedge parts, a Mandrake stays quiet, or the grass tells you who walked past.

The catch. Plants feel what you feel. When you are angry or frightened, the plants around you go wild. And Devil's Snare always grabs you first.

cut out, fold on the middle line, seal shut

FOR THE EYES OF THE

THORNBURY

and nobody else.

clay seal here

Open it alone. Tell no one.

THE THING NOBODY AT HOGWARTS KNOWS

Rat-Speech

Always. You can talk to rats. They know every crack, pipe and pantry in the castle.

Once a day. Send a rat to listen in a room or follow someone for one block. At the start of the next block, the DM tells you what it heard.

The catch. Rats are cowards and gossips: on a d20 of 1 to 5, it also tells someone else what you asked. And the caretaker's cat can smell rat on you, so after curfew you roll with disadvantage to stay hidden.

T1 Secret gift cards

Cut out, fold in half on the dotted line (the gift inside), and seal with a clay seal. Hand them out at the start of session 2.

cut out, fold on the middle line, seal shut

FOR THE EYES OF THE

QUILL

and nobody else.

clay seal here

Open it alone. Tell no one.

THE THING NOBODY AT HOGWARTS KNOWS

Mirror Self

Always. You can make a magical illusion of yourself. It looks, moves and smiles like you, but it cannot speak or touch anything.

Once a day. For one scene, send your illusion somewhere you are not: as a decoy, an alibi, or to walk into danger first. In a fight, the first attack that would hit you hits the illusion instead, and it pops.

The catch. While it is up you cannot cast spells. If it is hit or touched it bursts, and you feel it: 1d4 damage. And something else in this castle copies people. It has noticed you.

cut out, fold on the middle line, seal shut

FOR THE EYES OF THE

PENROSE

and nobody else.

clay seal here

Open it alone. Tell no one.

THE THING NOBODY AT HOGWARTS KNOWS

The Battered Suitcase

Always. You carry an old suitcase with the initials N.S. worn into the handle. Inside is a whole world of magical creatures, and they let you in.

Once a day. Let one creature out to help for a scene: a Niffler sniffs out something shiny or hidden, a Bowtruckle picks a small lock, or an Occamy squeezes into any gap to fetch something.

The catch. Things get out. Each morning the DM rolls a d20: on 1 to 4, something escaped in the night and is causing chaos somewhere in the castle. Catch it before a teacher does, or the case is confiscated. Professor Scamander would very much like to know where you got it.

T1 Secret gift cards

Cut out, fold in half on the dotted line (the gift inside), and seal with a clay seal. Hand them out at the start of session 2.

cut out, fold on the middle line, seal shut

FOR THE EYES OF THE

OKAFOR

and nobody else.

clay seal here

Open it alone. Tell no one.

THE THING NOBODY AT HOGWARTS KNOWS

The Invisibility Cloak

Always. You own a real Invisibility Cloak, silvery and light as water. Under it, nobody can see you.

Once a day. Its old magic tires: wear it for one scene a day. Unseen, you can slip past anyone, and in a fight your first attack has advantage (after that, they know where you are).

The catch. It hides you, not your sound, your smell or your footprints: the Marauder's Map still shows you, creatures smell you, ghosts walk straight through you, and Quill's Sight sees a shimmer. Two can hide under it only if both pass a DEX roll. If a teacher catches you in it, it is confiscated for a week.

Penrose: creature cards

FROM THE SUITCASE

Niffler

Sniffs out one shiny or hidden thing in the room. Ask the DM what it found.

FROM THE SUITCASE

Bowtruckle

Picks one small lock: a drawer, a box, a little chest. Not a door.

FROM THE SUITCASE

Occamy

Shrinks to fit any gap and fetches one small thing from the other side.

FROM THE SUITCASE

ESCAPED!

Something got out in the night. Hide this card until the DM asks for it.

T2 Family keepsakes

One small reminder of each family's secret. Tea-stain, tear the edges, and hand them out with the gift cards.

Blackwood: A torn page from your grandmother's diary

…and still the painted man waits. Mother said the Blackwoods owe him a debt, or that he owes us one; she would never say which.

Whatever you do, child, never let anyone unwrap a covered painting. Some of them are not empty.

— E. B.

Sinclair: A letter from your sister

Dear _____,

The castle feels wrong this year. The portraits go quiet when I walk past, and there's a covered painting on the third floor that nobody will admit putting there.

Don't tell Mum and Dad. Just keep an eye out for me when you get here. You're the only one I've told.

Your sister

Fenwick: A card from Fenwick's Fizzing Follies, Diagon Alley

FENWICK'S FIZZING FOLLIES

Jokes, japes and things your mother warned you about. Diagon Alley, next to the cauldron shop.

On the back, in your great-uncle's writing: "The words wake it. I never wrote them down. The boy with the other half has been watching. Be cleverer than he is."

Thornbury: Bramble's tag, torn in half

BRAMBLE

Hippogriff, grey and silver, five years old. Thornbury Farm, Welsh hills.

If found, please retur…

Tip: press this onto a flat clay tag, tear the clay edge while it is soft, and hang it on black yarn.

Quill: A note from home, and a sketch you don't remember drawing

Floss every night, write every week, and don't let anyone turn you into anything. We are so proud of you. Love, Mum and Dad.

On the back, in your own pencil: two eyes, drawn over and over, all of them looking at you.



Penrose: A programme from the Penrose Theatre, Penzance

THE PENROSE PLAYERS PRESENT: A HUNDRED FACES

In memory of Morwenna Penrose, who played every part in this company until the summer she sat for her portrait.

Pencilled in the margin: "She never changed her face again. The painting was never delivered. Where did it go?"

T2 Family keepsakes

One small reminder of each family's secret. Tea-stain, tear the edges, and hand them out with the gift cards.

Okafor: A carbon copy of your mum's Gringotts report

GRINGOTTS · CURSE-BREAKING REPORT

Item: one portrait, wrapped in grey cloth. **Destination:** Hogwarts School. **Inspector:** A. Okafor.

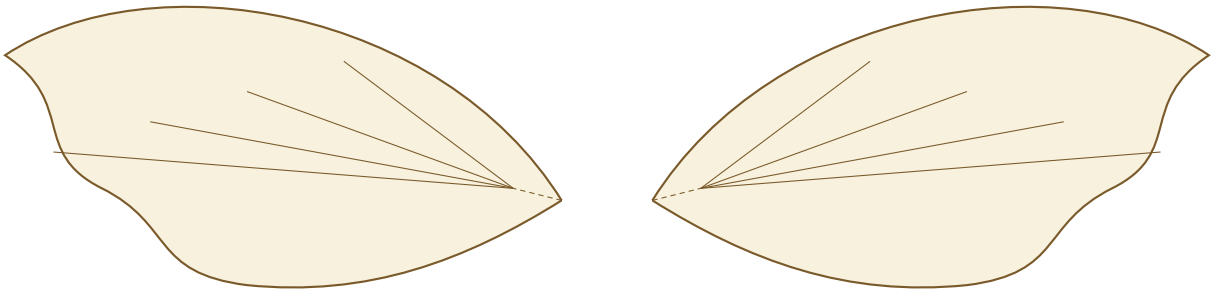
Finding: OCCUPIED. **Recommendation:** do not ship.

Stamped across the bottom in red: OVERRULED. SENT.

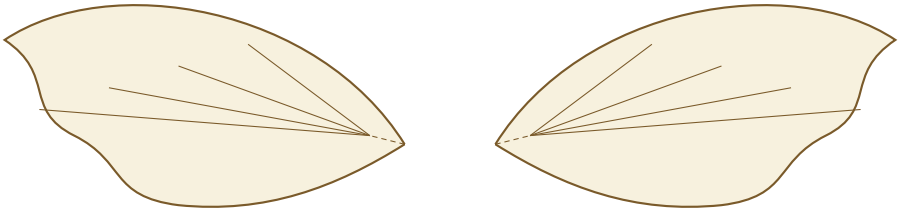
T3 Golden Snitch wings

Cut around each wing. Fold the short tab at the root and glue it into the slit you cut in the clay ball.

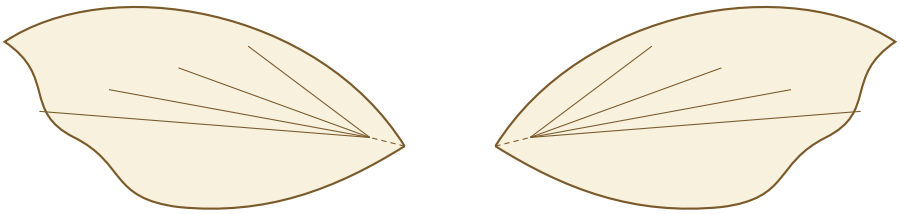
~~The Golden Snitch (for The Old Cup)~~



The small Snitch (Flying Lessons)



Spares



T4 Rune tablets

Lay a tablet on soft clay and press along every rune with a toothpick. Draw the picture in the circle the same way.

Rune tablet (beasts and sky) · A cracked slate from the Ancient Runes shelf

draw an owl here



draw a moon here



draw a star here



Rune tablet (garden) · A mossy slate wedged under a seed tray

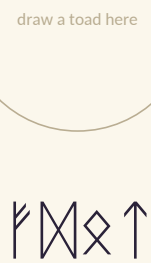
draw an apple here



draw a pine tree here



draw a toad here



Rune tablet (hearth) · A soot-black slate from beside a fireplace

draw a flame here



draw a key here



draw a fish here



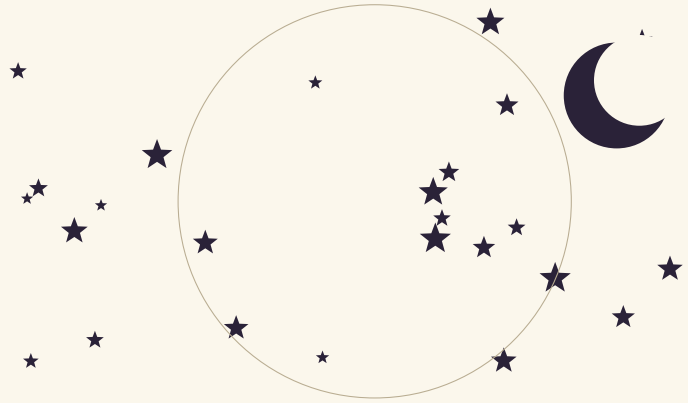
T5 The three ring clues

Tea-stain and cut out. Scratch the note with a pin. Roll the star chart and slide it into the Snitch. Fold the feathered card.

Scratched note (first ring): Trophy Room

“The first ring remembers what sleeps beneath the castle.”

Star chart (second ring): Astronomy Tower, inside the Snitch



“The second ring follows the lamp of the night.”

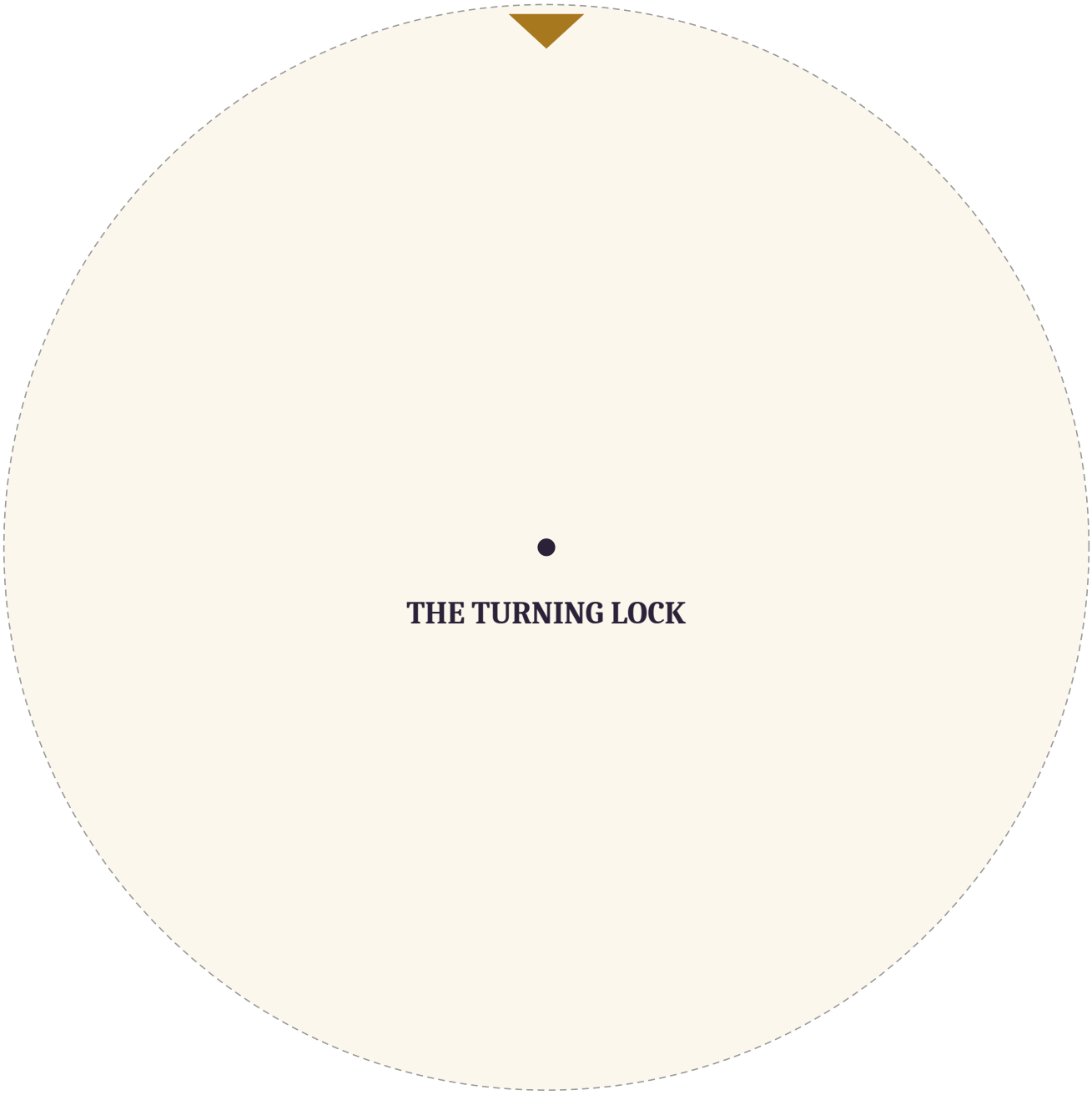
Feathered card (last ring): Owlery. Fold in half, glue a paper feather on the front

front: glue a feather here

“The last ring belongs to the one who carries every letter.”

T6 The Turning Lock (1 of 3): the base

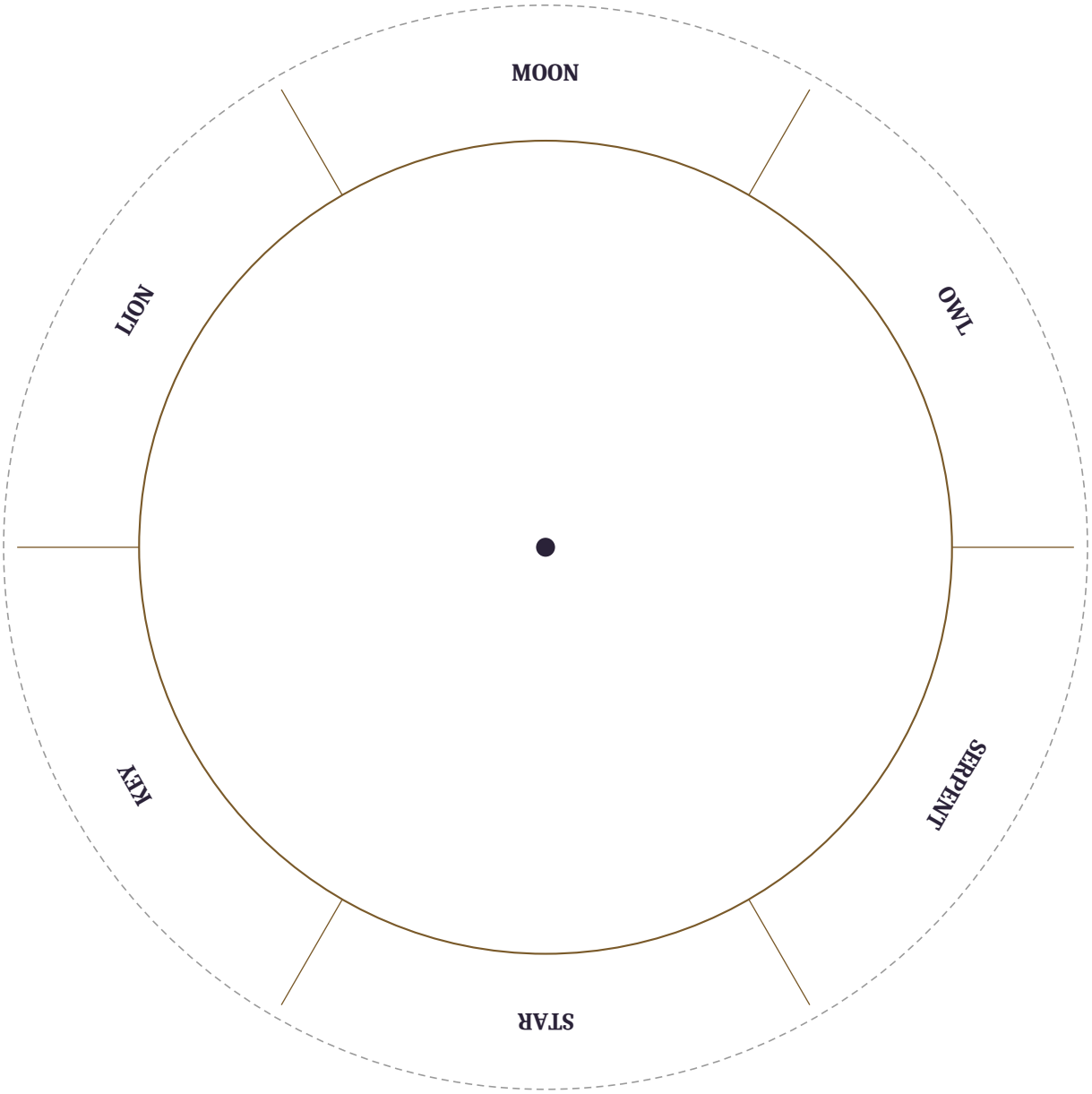
Glue every part onto card, then cut out. Stack: base, ring 1, ring 2, ring 3. Push a pencil through the centre dots. Only the rings turn.



The base stays still. The arrow points down at the three symbols that open the lock.

T6 The Turning Lock (2 of 3): ring 1

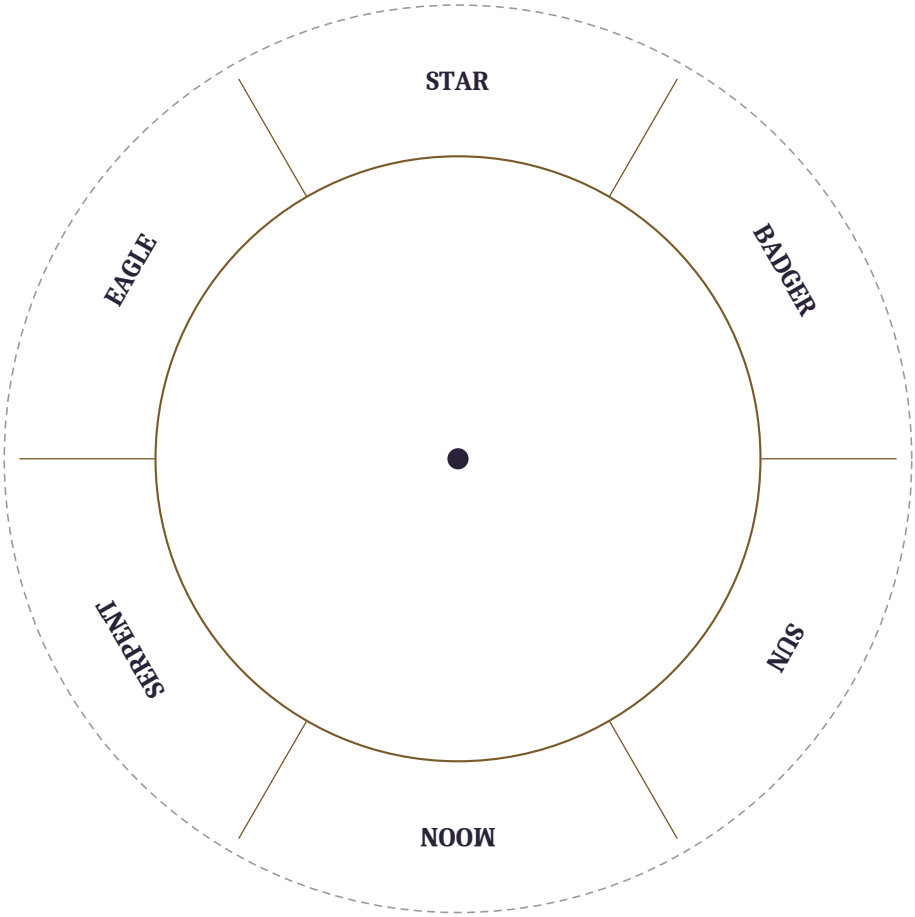
Ring 1 sits on the base. Its symbols go round the outside edge.



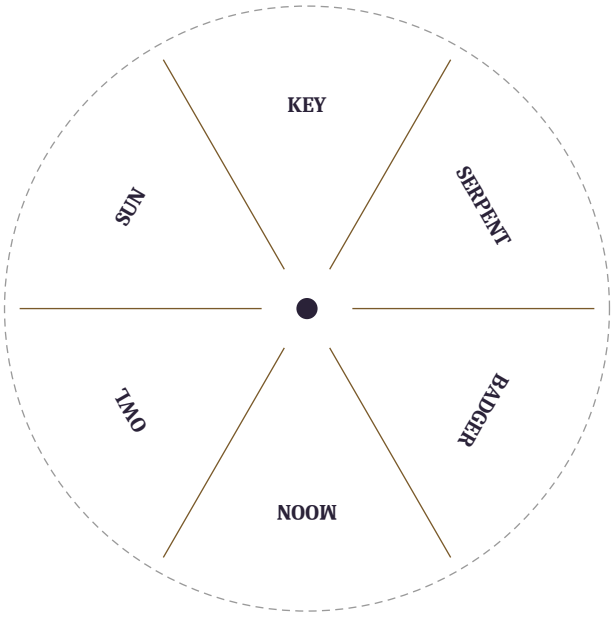
Ring 1 (outer)

T6 The Turning Lock (3 of 3): rings 2 and 3

Ring 2 sits on ring 1, ring 3 on top. Turn them until the right three symbols line up under the arrow.



Ring 2 (middle)



Ring 3 (inner)

T7 Vale’s diary and the torn map edge

Tea-stain these dark and tear the edges. Give each diary page as it is found in the app.

Diary page 1: Restricted Section (Day 3)

ᛞᛚᛊᚱ ᚠᛖᚦ ᛞᛚᚦ ᚢᛖᛞ ᛗᚠᛟᛚᛏᛖ ᛟᛊᛞᛚᚦ

Diary page 2: Black Lake (Day 4)

ᛇᛟᚱ ᛊᚦᛟᛒᛚ ᚠᛖᚦ ᛉᛈᛒᛗᚦ

Diary page 3: Shrieking Shack (Day 6)

ᚠᛖᛟᚠ ᛉᛟᛚᛚᛞᚠ ᚹᚦ ᚹᛊᛞᛉᚲᚦᛏ

The torn map edge: glue along the torn edge of the Fenwick half

◇ ᛗᛞᛊᚦᛇᛚᛊᚱ ᛗᚢᚦᛟᛒ ᚠᛖᛟᚠ

◇ ᛟᛇ ᛈᚺ ᚠᛞ ᛚᛞ ᛁᛞᛞᛏ

T8 The Seven Bottles

Wrap each label round its clay bottle and glue. Stand them in a row, 1 to 7, left to right, behind the riddle card.

Bottle 1: make it tall

1 · GREEN

Bottle 2: make it small

2 · RED

Bottle 3: make it round

3 · BLUE

Bottle 4: make it small

4 · GOLD

Bottle 5: make it tall

5 · PURPLE

Bottle 6: make it round

6 · GREEN

Bottle 7: make it tiny

7 · CLEAR

The riddle card

THE SEVEN BOTTLES

Seven bottles stand in a row. One lets you walk on through the fire. One leads safely back. Two bring a deep sleep. Three are poison. Only one of you may drink to go forward.

1. *No poison stands beside the way back.*
2. *No two poisons stand side by side.*
3. *Every tall bottle is poison.*
4. *The way back stands beside a sleeping draught.*
5. *The way forward is neither red nor clear.*
6. *The way forward stands somewhere to the left of the way back.*